

Daily Task – 5

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13/08/2026

CMMI Maturity Levels

Goal:

Use the 5-level CMMI scale to define process quality (Initial to Optimizing).

Key Concept

CMMI levels are cumulative — each level is built on the discipline of the one before it. You can't jump to measuring a process with data (L4) if it isn't standardized yet (L3), and you can't standardize something that isn't reliably happening yet (L2).

Maturity Ladder — 5 Steps

Level	Name	Definition
1	Initial	Chaotic and reactive. No repeatable process — success depends on individual effort and luck.
2	Managed	Basic discipline exists, but handled separately per task/project. Each one runs its own improvised system.
3	Defined	One standardized process, documented and used across the whole organization. New work just slots into it.
4	Quantitatively Managed	The process is tracked with real metrics — performance is measured, not assumed.
5	Optimizing	Metrics are used to find root causes and continuously improve the process itself.

Paying a Bill: Level 1 vs Level 5

Level 1 (Initial)

No system. You find out about a bill because it's sitting on the table or someone calls to remind you. Sometimes you're late, sometimes you're not — it depends purely on memory and luck, not process.

Level 5 (Optimizing)

Bills are logged in one standard system, tracked with metrics like % paid on time and days-early average, and the data is actively used to improve things — for example, switching a variable bill to a fixed-rate

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